Supplementary Table 4: Quality assessment table for included papers

<=5 low quality
6-7 moderate quality
8+ high quality

	Study/paper	Quality Assessment
1	Lowell A, Kildea S, Liddle M, et al. Supporting Aboriginal knowledge and practice in health care: lessons from a qualitative evaluation of the strong women, strong babies, strong culture program. *BMC Pregnancy & Childbirth* 2015;15(1):19-19. doi: 10.1186/s12884-015-0433-3	Qualitative: 7/10
2	Earle-Crane M. The Quality of Prenatal Care: Experiences of Women Attending Healthy Baby Clubs [Masters]. Memorial University of Newfoundland, 2000.	Qualitative: 7/10
3	United States Agency for International D. USAID/Burma Shaethot Final Performance Evaluation, Evaluation Report, 2018.	Mixed methods Qualitative: 7/10 Quantitative quasi-experimental: 7/9
4	Saville N. The effect of community mobilisation through women's groups on improved IYCF: Experience from Dhanusha, Nepal [Available from: http://siteresources.worldbank.org/SOUTHASIAEXT/Resources/223546-1328913542665/UCL-MIRA_DHANUSHA.pdf.}	Quantitative RCT: 2/13 on what is presented. Note: Unclear/low based on details in presentation but moderate to high from protocol paper in Trials (no outcomes reported).
5	Ministry of Health, UNICEF Sri Lanka. Review of the Functioning and Impact of Mother Support Groups in the Northern and Eastern Provinces of Sri Lanka 2015 [Available from: https://www.unicef.org/srilanka/media/336/file/MOTHER%20SUPPORT%20GROUPS.pdf.	Mixed methods Qualitative: 6/10 Quantitative: <3/10 Note: Assessed quantitative under both cross-sectional and cohort studies; quality low on both.
6	Roy SS, Mahapatra R, Rath S, et al. Improved neonatal survival after participatory learning and action with women's groups: a prospective study in rural eastern India. *Bull World Health Organ* 2013;91(6):426-33B. doi: 10.2471/BLT.12.10517110.2471/BLT.12.105171. Epub 2013 Apr 4. [published Online First: 2013/09/21]	Quantitative prospective cohort: 7/11

7	Gill, K. 1999. If we walk together – communities, NGOs, and Government in partnership for health: the Hyderabad experience, The World Bank, Washington DC.	Qualitative: 5/10 Note: Method unclear
8	Ndirangu, G., Gichangi, A., Kanyuuru, L., Otai, J., Mulindi, R., Lynam, P., . . . Archer, L. (2015). Using young mothers' clubs to improve knowledge of postpartum hemorrhage and family planning in informal settlements in Nairobi, Kenya. *Journal of Community Health*, 40(4), 692-698. doi:10.1007/s10900-014-9986-8	Quantitative: quasi-experimental 5/9
9	Gram, L., Skordis-Worrall, J., Manandhar, D. S., Strachan, D., Morrison, J., Saville, N., . . . Heys, M. (2018). The long-term impact of community mobilisation through participatory women's groups on women's agency in the household: A follow-up study to the makwanpur trial. *PloS One*, 13(5), e0197426. doi:10.1371/journal.pone.0197426	Quantitative quasi-experimental: 7-8/9
10	Roche, M. L., Ambato, L., Sarsoza, J., & Kuhnlein, H. V. (2017). Mothers' groups enrich diet and culture through promoting traditional quichua foods. *Maternal & Child Nutrition*, 13(S3), e12530-n/a. doi:10.1111/mcn.12530	Mixed Methods Quantitative:9 cross-sectional: 4/8 Qualitative: 8/10
11	Kruske, S., Schmied, V., Sutton, I., & O'Hare, J. (2004). Mothers' experiences of facilitated peer support groups and individual child health nursing support: A comparative evaluation. *Journal of Perinatal Education*, 13(3), 31-38. doi:10.1624/105812404X1752	Qualitative: 8/10
12	O'Rourke, K., Howard-Grabman, L., & Seoane, G. (1998). Impact of community organization of women on perinatal outcomes in rural bolivia. *Revista Panamericana De Salud Pública*, 3(1), 9-14. doi:10.1590/S1020-49891998000100002	Quantitative quasi-experimental: 5/9
13	Manandhar, D. S., Osrin, D., Shrestha, B. P., Mesko, N., Morrison, J., Tumbahangphe, K. M., . . . Members of the MIRA Makwanpur trial team. (2004). Effect of a participatory intervention with women's groups on birth outcomes in Nepal: Cluster-randomised controlled trial. *The Lancet*, 364(9438), 970-979. doi:10.1016/S0140-6736(04)17021-9	Quantitative cluster RCT: 10/13
14	Quigley, P., Green, C., Soyoola, M., Kureya, T., Barber, C., & Mubuyaeta, K. (2018). Empowering women and communities to promote universal health coverage in rural zambia. *Development in Practice,* 28(8), 1094-1100. doi:10.1080/09614524.2018.1508421	Quantitative quasi-experimental: 4/9
15	Skordis, J., Pace, N., Vera-Hernandez, M., Rasul, I., Fitzsimons, E., Osrin, D., . . . Costello, A. (2019). Family networks and healthy behaviour: Evidence from Nepal. *Health Economics, Policy and Law*, 14(2), 231-248. doi:http://dx.doi.org.elibrary.jcu.edu.au/10.1017/S1744133118000130	Quantitative: cross-sectional: 7-8/8

16	Tripathy, P., Nair, N., Barnett, S., Mahapatra, R., Borghi, J., Rath, S., . . . Costello, A., (2010). Effect of a participatory intervention with women's groups on birth outcomes and maternal depression in Jharkhand and Orissa, India: A cluster-randomised controlled trial. *The Lancet*, 375(9721), 1182-1192. doi:10.1016/S0140-6736(09)62042-0	Quantitative RCT: 10/13
17	Damtew, Z. A., Karim, A. M., Chekagn, C. T., Fesseha Zemichael, N., Yihun, B., Willey, B. A., & Betemariam, W. (2018). Correlates of the women's development army strategy implementation strength with household reproductive, maternal, newborn and child healthcare practices: A cross-sectional study in four regions of Ethiopia. *BMC Pregnancy and Childbirth,* 18(Suppl 1), 373. doi:10.1186/s12884-018-1975-y	Quantitative cross-sectional: 7/8
18	Turan, J. M., Say, L., Güngör, A. K., Demarco, R., & Yazgan, S. (2003). Community participation for perinatal health in Istanbul. *Health Promotion International,* 18(1), 25-32. doi:10.1093/heapro/18.1.25	Mixed Methods Qualitative: 1/10 Quantitative: cross-sectional 0/8
19	Bolton, M., Moore, I., Ferreira, A., Day, C., & Bolton, D. (2016). Community organizing and community health: Piloting an innovative approach to community engagement applied to an early intervention project in South London. *Journal of Public Health*38(1), 115-121. doi:10.1093/pubmed/fdv017	Quantitative: quasi-experimental 4/9
20	Wong, M.L., Chen, P.Y.C. 1991, Self-reliance in health among village women, *World Health Forum*, 12, 43-48	Qualitative: 4/10
21	Rath, S., Nair, N., Tripathy, P. K., Barnett, S., Rath, S., Mahapatra, R., . . . Prost, A. (2010). Explaining the impact of a women's group led community mobilisation intervention on maternal and newborn health outcomes: The Ekjut trial process evaluation. *BMC International Health and Human Rights,* 10(1), 25-25. doi:10.1186/1472-698X-10-25	Mixed Methods Qualitative: 7+/10 Quantitative: cross-sectional 2/8
22	Pant, P. R., Budhathoki, B., Ellis, M., Manandhar, D., Deave, T., & Mytton, J. (2015). The feasibility of community mobilisation for child injury prevention in rural Nepal: A programme for female community health volunteers. *BMC Public Health*, 15(1), 430. doi:10.1186/s12889-015-1783-5	Quantitative: Cross-sectional 3/8 Note: Not really a Qualitative component but rated Qualitative: 5/10
23	Nishiuchi, M. 1985, Mothers in community health care activities-The Suita Mother's Club, *JOICFP Review* (Japanese Organization for International Cooperation in Family Planning (JOICFP). 8, 5-29	Narrative text and opinion: 3/6

24	Morrison, J., Osrin, D., Alcock, G., Azad, K., Bamjan, J., Budhathoki, B., . . . Houweling, T. A. J. (2019). Exploring the equity impact of a maternal and newborn health intervention: A qualitative study of participatory women's groups in rural south Asia and Africa. *International Journal for Equity in Health*, 18(1), 55. doi:10.1186/s12939-019-0957-7	Qualitative: 7/10
25	Morrison, J., Thapa, R., Sen, A., Neupane, R., Borghi, J., Tumbahangphe, K. M., . . . Costello, A. (2010). Utilization and management of maternal and child health funds in rural Nepal. *Community Development Journal,* 45(1), 75-89. doi:10.1093/cdj/bsn029	Qualitative: 10/10
26	Morrison, J., Thapa, R., Hartley, S., Osrin, D., Manandhar, M., Tumbahangphe, K., . . . Costello, A. (2010). Understanding how women's groups improve maternal and newborn health in Makwanpur, Nepal: A qualitative study. *International Health,* 2(1), 25-35. doi:10.1016/j.inhe.2009.11.004	Qualitative: 9/10
27	Morrison, J., Tamang, S., Mesko, N., Osrin, D., Shrestha, B., Manandhar, M., . . . Costello, A. (2005). Women's health groups to improve perinatal care in rural Nepal. *BMC Pregnancy and Childbirth*, 5(1), 6-6. doi:10.1186/1471-2393-5-6	Qualitative: 10/10
28	Lugo, N. R. (1996). Empowerment Education: A Case Study of the Resource Sisters/Compañeras Program. *Health Education Quarterly*, 23(3), 281–289. https://doi.org/10.1177/109019819602300301	Mixed methods. Quantitative cross-sectional: 2/8 Qualitative: 0/10
29	Dongre, A.R., Deshmukh, P.R. & Garg, B.S. A community based approach to improve health care seeking for newborn danger signs in rural Wardha, India. *Indian J Pediatr* 76, 45–50 (2009). https://doi-org.elibrary.jcu.edu.au/10.1007/s12098-009-0028-y	Mixed Methods Quantitative: quasi-experimental 4/9 Qualitative: 5/10
30	Dickinson, Pauline and Joe, Tara. Strengthening Young Mothers: A Qualitative Evaluation of a Pilot Support Group Program [online]. *Youth Studies Australia,* Vol. 29, No. 1, Mar 2010: 35-44. Availability: <https://search-informit-com-au.elibrary.jcu.edu.au/documentSummary;dn=950418632305501;res=IELHSS> ISSN: 1038-2569.	Qualitative: 7/10
31	Tripathy, P., Nair, N., Sinha, R., Rath, S., Gope, R. K., Rath, S., Roy SS, Bajpai A, Singh V, Nath V, Ali S, Kundu AK, Choudhury D, Ghosh SK, Kumar S, Mahapatra R,. . . Prost, A. (2016). Effect of participatory women's groups facilitated by accredited social health activists on birth outcomes in rural eastern india: A cluster-randomised controlled trial. *The Lancet Global Health*, 4(2), e119-e128. doi:10.1016/S2214-109X(15)00287-9	Quantitative cluster randomised controlled trial: 12/13

32	Morrison, J., Tumbahangphe, K., Sen, A., Gram, L., Budhathoki, B., Neupane, R., . . . Osrin, D. (2020). Health management committee strengthening and community mobilisation through women's groups to improve trained health worker attendance at birth in rural Nepal: a cluster randomised controlled trial. *BMC Pregnancy & Childbirth, 20*(1), 268. doi:https://dx.doi.org/10.1186/s12884-020-02960-6	Quantitative cluster randomised trial: 10/13
33	Ronaasen, J., Steenkamp, L., Williams, M., Finnemore, J., & Feeley, A. (2020). SAKHA ESETHU: nurturing value-centered group work for a community-based parent support Programme in the Eastern Cape, South Africa. *Social Work with Groups.* doi:http://dx.doi.org/10.1080/01609513.2020.1828227	Qualitative study: 6/10
34	Sharma, S., Mehra, D., Akhtar, F., & Mehra, S. (2020). Evaluation of a community-based intervention for health and economic empowerment of marginalized women in India. *BMC Public Health, 20*(1), 1766. doi:https://dx.doi.org/10.1186/s12889-020-09884-y	Mixed methods evaluation Quantitative: 2/9 Qualitative: 6/10
35	Colburn, T.,Nambiar, B., Bondo, A., Makwenda, C., Tsetekani, E., Makonda-Ridley,A., Msukwa, M., Barker, P., Kotagal, U., Williams, C., Davies, R., Webb, D., Flatman, D., Lewycka, S., Rosato, M., Kachale, F., Mwansambo, C. & Costello, A. Effects of quality improvement in health facilities and community mobilization through women's groups on maternal, neonatal and perinatal mortality in three districts of Malawi: MaiKhanda, a cluster randomized controlled effectiveness trial, *International Health*, Volume 5, Issue 3, September 2013, Pages 180–195, https://doi.org/10.1093/inthealth/iht011	Quantitative factorial cluster randomised trial 11/13